

ASSESSING YOUTH KNOWLEDGE AND UNDERSTANDING OF SEXUAL HEALTH

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Background

- ☀ The number of sexually transmitted infections (STIs) and HIV cases among Thai youth aged 15–24 has been steadily increasing.
- ☀ Many young people remain unaware of their risk of infection and have limited knowledge of sexual health.
- ☀ This project was initiated to assess young peoples’ understanding of sexual health, and to develop suitable educational materials to enhance their knowledge.



Objectives

1. To assess the level of knowledge and understanding of sexual health among young people.
2. To identify approaches for developing appropriate educational materials that enhance young peoples’ sexual health knowledge and understanding.



Intervention

- ☀ From January to July 2025, Buddy CU Clinic developed a 10-item questionnaire focusing on common misconceptions regarding sexual health among youth.
- ☀ The survey targeted youth aged 15–24 years from Suankularb Wittayalai School and Kasetsart University. Participants completed the questionnaire via Google Forms. The findings informed the design of targeted educational materials and strategies for youth engagement.

ลำดับ	คำถาม	ใช่	ไม่ใช่
1	ดูยาเสพติดเป็นยาดีที่ช่วยคลายเครียด	✓	
2	ยาเสพติดเป็นยาดีที่ช่วยคลายเครียด		✓
3	การมีเพศสัมพันธ์ คือการมีเพศสัมพันธ์	✓	
4	การมีเพศสัมพันธ์ คือ การมีเพศสัมพันธ์	✓	
5	การมีเพศสัมพันธ์ คือ การมีเพศสัมพันธ์	✓	
6	การมีเพศสัมพันธ์ คือ การมีเพศสัมพันธ์	✓	
7	การมีเพศสัมพันธ์ คือ การมีเพศสัมพันธ์	✓	
8	การมีเพศสัมพันธ์ คือ การมีเพศสัมพันธ์	✓	
9	การมีเพศสัมพันธ์ คือ การมีเพศสัมพันธ์	✓	
10	การมีเพศสัมพันธ์ คือ การมีเพศสัมพันธ์	✓	



Results



- ☀ A total of 394 youth participated: 54% female, 39% male, and 7% LGBTQ. One third (33%) were aged 15–19 years and 67% were aged 20–24 years.
- ☀ The median of correct responses was 7.
- ☀ Knowledge gaps were observed, in particular in the following areas:
 - ▶ 36% of respondents were unaware of syphilis treatment, and 58% could not identify syphilis symptoms.
 - ▶ 37% were unfamiliar with gonorrhea treatment.
 - ▶ Regarding HIV-related knowledge: 39% were unfamiliar with HIV pre-exposure prophylaxis (PrEP), 43% did not understand the concept of “U=U” (Undetectable = Untransmittable), and 43% incorrectly believed that sharing food with a person living with HIV could transmit the virus.
- ☀ An educational video was developed and disseminated via Instagram and TikTok to provide accurate sexual health information, reaching 80 viewers.

Conclusion

- ☀ There are Thai youth misconceptions and gaps in knowledge regarding the prevention, symptoms, and treatment of sexually transmitted infections (STIs) and HIV.
- ☀ Such misconceptions reflect underlying limitations in access to accurate sexual health information, inadequate emphasis on comprehensive sexual education, and the persistence of social stigma surrounding discussions of HIV.
- ☀ Without targeted and sustained educational interventions, these gaps may contribute to continued high rates of infection among young people.

Recommendations

Materials targeting youth should be age-appropriate, engaging, and visually appealing. They should address commonly identified misconceptions. Outreach to youth can be through popular social media channels to maximize engagement and reach.

